

# Supplementary Information

## Viscereality: Bioresponsive Virtual Reality for Box Breathing and Altered-State Experience

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## S1 Deviations from preregistration

The preregistered phase-duration adherence measure was replaced by phase-locking value (PLV) because the recorded phase labels were too fragmented for stable phase-duration estimation without additional segmentation rules. The associated requirement of at least 70% valid cycles and the two-standard-deviation phase-error exclusion rule were replaced by a pooled lower-tail IQR rule applied to condition-level PLV values.

For every non-PLV outcome, the preregistered order-adjusted repeated-measures analysis tests the condition effect after accounting for participant and numeric block position. It is implemented as a partial- $F$  comparison between a participant-and-order model and the same model plus condition. Participant fixed effects provide within-participant blocking, and block position adjusts for presentation order. The finalized PLV omnibus remains unchanged. The two preregistered contrasts, pooled VR versus dark-screen control and symmetric versus asymmetric VR, were implemented as paired  $t$ -tests.

Wilcoxon signed-rank and Friedman tests were added as distribution-free checks. Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery-rate correction was applied within each multi-test outcome family because the preregistration did not specify a multiplicity procedure. The subsequently published 3D-ASC<sub>r</sub> scoring system was applied to the registered 11D-ASC scores as a post-registration higher-order summary; complete analyses of all 11 subscales remain in Section S3. Pictograph–ASC correspondence, condition-by-PLV models, and ASC–tracer correspondence analyses were treated as exploratory. All inferential analyses used the final included sample of  $N = 39$ .

The preregistration also specified correlations between each tracer summary and the corresponding retrospective ASC dimension. These were not implemented as inferential correlations because the three condition-level observations were nested within participants and no dependence-aware correspondence model had been specified. Section S5 therefore reports descriptive profile convergence only; formal tracer validity remains to be established in a dedicated dependence-aware analysis.

## S2 PLV computation and quality screening

### S2.1 Phase-locking value

PLV was calculated between the normalized sphere-radius trajectory displayed during each block and the ideal sphere-radius trajectory generated from the audio-instruction timing. Samples for which either series was non-finite were removed. Each series was mean-centred, and instantaneous phase was obtained from its analytic signal. Blocks with fewer than 20 paired finite samples were treated as missing.

For participant  $j$  in condition  $c$ ,

$$\text{PLV}_{jc} = \left| \frac{1}{T} \sum_{t=1}^T \exp(i[\phi_{jct}^{\text{observed}} - \phi_t^{\text{reference}}]) \right|, \quad (\text{S1})$$

where  $T$  is the number of paired finite samples. PLV ranges from 0 to 1, with larger values indicating a more stable phase relationship. PLV does not measure respiratory depth or tidal volume.

### S2.2 Screening rule and exclusions

The screening distribution contained the three condition-level PLV values from each of the 47 tested participants. The lower fence was calculated as

$$Q_1 - 1.5(Q_3 - Q_1), \quad (\text{S2})$$

with  $Q_1 = 0.695346$  and  $Q_3 = 0.914776$ , producing a cutoff of 0.366201. A participant was excluded from all conditions if any condition-level PLV was below the cutoff. Table S1 lists the excluded participants and their condition-level values. The remaining 39 participants formed the analytic sample used for all inferential analyses.

**Table S1** Condition-level PLV values for participants excluded by the pooled lower-tail IQR quality-screening rule. Values below the cutoff of 0.366201 are marked with an asterisk. If any condition was flagged, the participant was excluded from all three conditions.

| Participant | Dark-screen control | Symmetric VR | Asymmetric VR | Below-cutoff condition(s)       |
|-------------|---------------------|--------------|---------------|---------------------------------|
| P08         | 0.487994            | 0.641091     | 0.363136*     | Asymmetric                      |
| P12         | 0.045540*           | 0.858897     | 0.651905      | Dark-screen control             |
| P16         | 0.322388*           | 0.424615     | 0.923065      | Dark-screen control             |
| P18         | 0.046679*           | 0.424962     | 0.105354*     | Dark-screen control; asymmetric |
| P23         | 0.950082            | 0.033076*    | 0.048964*     | Symmetric; asymmetric           |
| P27         | 0.859589            | 0.488851     | 0.336871*     | Asymmetric                      |
| P32         | 0.723235            | 0.493400     | 0.101153*     | Asymmetric                      |
| P40         | 0.441212            | 0.267064*    | 0.245893*     | Symmetric; asymmetric           |

## S3 11D-ASC: Altered States of Consciousness Rating Scale

This section reports analyses of the 11 dimensions of the Altered States of Consciousness Rating Scale (11D-ASC; Studerus et al. 2010), grouped under the Positive, Distressing, and Perceptual Effects composites reported in the main article. Within each composite, we compare the constituent dimensions' pooled-VR-minus-dark-screen-control mean differences to identify the principal contributors to the higher-order result. These comparisons are descriptive and do not estimate independent or causal effects. Benjamini–Hochberg  $q_{FDR}$  values control the false-discovery rate across all 11 dimensions within each test family, rather than separately within each higher-order composite.

### S3.1 Positive Effects

**Table S2** Positive Effects dimensions ranked by paired Cohen's  $d_z$  for the pooled-VR-versus-dark-screen-control contrast.

| Dimension                   | Mean difference [95% CI] | Paired Cohen's $d_z$ | $p$  | $q_{FDR}$ |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|------|-----------|
| Experience of Unity         | 13.10 [5.53, 20.68]      | 0.56                 | .001 | .004      |
| Changed Meaning of Percepts | 9.56 [3.69, 15.42]       | 0.53                 | .002 | .006      |
| Disembodiment               | 8.45 [1.84, 15.07]       | 0.41                 | .014 | .025      |
| Spiritual Experience        | 6.60 [1.43, 11.77]       | 0.41                 | .014 | .025      |
| Insightfulness              | 3.74 [−0.91, 8.39]       | 0.26                 | .112 | .136      |
| Blissful State              | 1.56 [−6.00, 9.13]       | 0.07                 | .678 | .746      |

*Note.* Mean differences are pooled-VR-minus-dark-screen-control differences on the 0–100 scale; brackets show 95% confidence intervals.  $d_z$  is Cohen's standardized effect size for paired observations. Benjamini–Hochberg  $q$  values are calculated across all 11 dimensions, not separately within each higher-order composite.

#### Experience of Unity.

Ratings were higher in symmetric VR ( $M = 34.36$ ,  $SD = 27.78$ ) and asymmetric VR ( $M = 35.68$ ,  $SD = 25.81$ ) than in the dark-screen control ( $M = 21.92$ ,  $SD = 22.33$ ). The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The corresponding Bayesian evidence was  $BF_{10} = 64.02$ ; the data were approximately 64 times more likely under a model containing condition than under the order-only model. Pooled VR exceeded the control,  $t(38) = 3.50$ ,  $d_z = 0.56$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .004$ ,  $BF_{10} = 26.15$ , whereas symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ,  $t(38) = -0.48$ ,  $d_z = -0.08$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  $BF_{01} = 5.20$ . The repeated-measures ANOVA and distribution-free analyses supported the same conclusion. The directional tests favored asymmetric VR over control,  $BF_{10} = 87.69$ , but not symmetric over asymmetric VR,  $BF_{01} = 8.07$ . Exploratory checks found neither an order effect ( $q_{FDR} = .934$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{FDR} = .872$ ). Both VR conditions increased Experience of Unity relative to control, with no meaningful difference between the two VR mappings.

139 There was no reliable evidence that the result was influenced by the order in which  
140 participants underwent the three conditions.

141

#### 142 **Changed Meaning of Percepts.**

143 Ratings were higher in symmetric VR ( $M = 19.93$ ,  $SD = 19.65$ ) and asymmet-  
144 ric VR ( $M = 20.41$ ,  $SD = 20.62$ ) than in the dark-screen control ( $M = 10.62$ ,  
145  $SD = 10.77$ ). The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGIS-**  
146 **TERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The  
147 corresponding Bayesian evidence was  $BF_{10} = 12.56$ ; the data were approximately 13  
148 times more likely under the condition model than under the order-only model. Pooled  
149 VR exceeded the control,  $t(38) = 3.30$ ,  $d_z = 0.53$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .006$ ,  $BF_{10} = 15.81$ ,  
150 whereas symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ,  $t(38) = -0.17$ ,  $d_z = -0.03$ ,  
151  $q_{FDR} = .866$ ,  $BF_{01} = 5.72$ . The repeated-measures ANOVA and distribution-free anal-  
152 yses supported the same conclusion. Exploratory checks found neither an order effect  
153 ( $q_{FDR} = .345$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{FDR} = .819$ ). Both VR condi-  
154 tions increased Changed Meaning of Percepts relative to control, without evidence of  
155 a difference between the two mappings. There was no reliable evidence that the result  
156 was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

157

#### 158 **Disembodiment.**

159 Ratings were higher in symmetric VR ( $M = 29.55$ ,  $SD = 27.87$ ) and asymmet-  
160 ric VR ( $M = 30.40$ ,  $SD = 25.49$ ) than in the dark-screen control ( $M = 21.52$ ,  
161  $SD = 22.40$ ). The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGIS-**  
162 **TERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The  
163 corresponding Bayesian evidence was  $BF_{10} = 4.94$ ; the data were approximately five  
164 times more likely under the condition model than under the order-only model. Pooled  
165 VR exceeded the control,  $t(38) = 2.59$ ,  $d_z = 0.41$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .025$ ,  $BF_{10} = 3.17$ , whereas  
166 symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ,  $t(38) = -0.39$ ,  $d_z = -0.06$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  
167  $BF_{01} = 5.39$ . The repeated-measures ANOVA supported the condition effect, while  
168 the FDR-adjusted Friedman result was weaker. Exploratory checks found neither an  
169 order effect ( $q_{FDR} = .817$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{FDR} = .872$ ). VR  
170 increased Disembodiment relative to control, without a difference between the VR  
171 mappings. There was no reliable evidence that the result was influenced by the order  
172 in which participants underwent the three conditions.

173

#### 174 **Spiritual Experience.**

175 Ratings were higher in symmetric VR ( $M = 17.97$ ,  $SD = 22.77$ ) and asymmet-  
176 ric VR ( $M = 18.91$ ,  $SD = 22.91$ ) than in the dark-screen control ( $M = 11.85$ ,  
177  $SD = 17.12$ ). The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGIS-**  
178 **TERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The  
179 corresponding Bayesian evidence was  $BF_{10} = 5.60$ ; the data were approximately six  
180 times more likely under the condition model than under the order-only model. Pooled  
181 VR exceeded the control,  $t(38) = 2.58$ ,  $d_z = 0.41$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .025$ ,  $BF_{10} = 3.13$ , whereas  
182 symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ,  $t(38) = -0.60$ ,  $d_z = -0.10$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  
183  $BF_{01} = 4.90$ . The repeated-measures ANOVA and distribution-free analyses supported  
184 the same conclusion. Exploratory checks found neither an order effect ( $q_{FDR} = .817$ )

nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{\text{FDR}} = .872$ ). VR increased Spiritual Experience relative to control, without evidence of a difference between the two mappings. There was no reliable evidence that the result was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

#### Insightfulness.

Mean ratings were 17.54 ( $SD = 18.11$ ) in the dark-screen control, 22.42 ( $SD = 21.33$ ) in symmetric VR, and 20.14 ( $SD = 18.56$ ) in asymmetric VR. The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The Bayesian analysis favored the order-only model,  $\text{BF}_{01} = 3.31$ ; the observed data were approximately three times more likely without a condition effect. Neither pooled VR versus control,  $t(38) = 1.63$ ,  $d_z = 0.26$ ,  $q_{\text{FDR}} = .136$ ,  $\text{BF}_{01} = 1.73$ , nor symmetric versus asymmetric VR,  $t(38) = 0.84$ ,  $d_z = 0.13$ ,  $q_{\text{FDR}} = .766$ ,  $\text{BF}_{01} = 4.16$ , provided reliable evidence of a difference. The sensitivity and distribution-free analyses agreed. Exploratory checks found neither an order effect ( $q_{\text{FDR}} = .980$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{\text{FDR}} = .819$ ). Insightfulness was descriptively higher during VR, but the tests did not establish a reliable condition effect. There was no reliable evidence that it was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

#### Blissful State.

Mean ratings were 29.86 ( $SD = 21.60$ ) in the dark-screen control, 29.63 ( $SD = 23.30$ ) in symmetric VR, and 33.22 ( $SD = 25.51$ ) in asymmetric VR. The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The Bayesian analysis favored the order-only model,  $\text{BF}_{01} = 7.62$ ; the data were approximately eight times more likely without a condition effect. Neither pooled VR versus control,  $t(38) = 0.42$ ,  $d_z = 0.07$ ,  $q_{\text{FDR}} = .746$ ,  $\text{BF}_{01} = 5.34$ , nor symmetric versus asymmetric VR,  $t(38) = -1.31$ ,  $d_z = -0.21$ ,  $q_{\text{FDR}} = .766$ ,  $\text{BF}_{01} = 2.61$ , provided reliable evidence of a difference. The sensitivity and distribution-free analyses agreed, and the directional tests did not support either registered step. Exploratory checks found neither an order effect ( $q_{\text{FDR}} = .934$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{\text{FDR}} = .872$ ). Blissful State did not differ reliably among the three conditions. There was no reliable evidence that it was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

### S3.2 Distressing Effects

**Table S3** Distressing Effects dimensions ranked by paired Cohen’s  $d_z$  for the pooled-VR-versus-dark-screen-control contrast.

| Dimension                      | Mean difference [95% CI] | Paired Cohen’s $d_z$ | $p$  | $q_{FDR}$ |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|------|-----------|
| Impaired Control and Cognition | 5.47 [0.32, 10.62]       | 0.34                 | .038 | .060      |
| Anxiety                        | 4.22 [−0.23, 8.67]       | 0.31                 | .063 | .086      |

*Note.* Mean differences are pooled-VR-minus-dark-screen-control differences on the 0–100 scale; brackets show 95% confidence intervals.  $d_z$  is Cohen’s standardized effect size for paired observations. Benjamini–Hochberg  $q$  values are calculated across all 11 dimensions, not separately within each higher-order composite.

#### Impaired Control and Cognition.

Mean ratings were 19.17 ( $SD = 16.50$ ) in the dark-screen control, 24.17 ( $SD = 20.02$ ) in symmetric VR, and 25.12 ( $SD = 18.97$ ) in asymmetric VR. The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The preregistered pooled-VR contrast likewise provided weak nominal evidence,  $t(38) = 2.15$ ,  $p = .038$ ,  $d_z = 0.34$ , but not correction-robust evidence ( $q_{FDR} = .060$ ). The corresponding Bayes factors did not clearly distinguish the effect and null models ( $BF_{10} = 1.10$  and 1.35, respectively). Symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ,  $t(38) = -0.51$ ,  $p = .615$ ,  $d_z = -0.08$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  $BF_{01} = 5.14$ . The Friedman check detected a distributional difference, but this secondary rank-based test did not assess the same mean-difference estimand or adjust for presentation order. Exploratory checks found neither an FDR-retained order effect ( $q_{FDR} = .682$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{FDR} = .872$ ). Impaired Control and Cognition was higher during pooled VR by a modest amount, but the frequentist evidence was weak and sensitive to family correction, and the Bayesian evidence was inconclusive. There was no reliable evidence that it was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

#### Anxiety.

Mean ratings were 5.49 ( $SD = 7.54$ ) in the dark-screen control, 10.49 ( $SD = 13.83$ ) in symmetric VR, and 8.92 ( $SD = 13.66$ ) in asymmetric VR. The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is **[REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]**. The Bayesian analysis slightly favored the order-only model,  $BF_{01} = 1.34$ . The pooled-VR contrast was also inconclusive,  $t(38) = 1.92$ ,  $d_z = 0.31$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .086$ ,  $BF_{01} = 1.11$ , while symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ,  $t(38) = 0.86$ ,  $d_z = 0.14$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  $BF_{01} = 4.10$ . The distribution-free results were similarly not significant after correction. The exploratory order effect was nominally significant before correction but not after it ( $p = .015$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .085$ ); the condition-by-order interaction was not supported ( $q_{FDR} = .872$ ). Anxiety was descriptively higher during VR, but the condition difference did not provide correction-robust evidence. There was no reliable evidence that it was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

### S3.3 Perceptual Effects

**Table S4** Perceptual Effects dimensions ranked by paired Cohen’s  $d_z$  for the pooled-VR-versus-dark-screen-control contrast.

| Dimension                | Mean difference [95% CI] | Paired Cohen’s $d_z$ | $p$    | $q_{FDR}$ |
|--------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|--------|-----------|
| Audio-Visual Synesthesia | 25.56 [15.52, 35.61]     | 0.82                 | < .001 | < .001    |
| Elementary Imagery       | 19.92 [11.35, 28.49]     | 0.75                 | < .001 | < .001    |
| Complex Imagery          | −0.45 [−7.73, 6.83]      | −0.02                | .901   | .901      |

*Note.* Mean differences are pooled-VR-minus-dark-screen-control differences on the 0–100 scale; brackets show 95% confidence intervals.  $d_z$  is Cohen’s standardized effect size for paired observations. Benjamini–Hochberg  $q$  values are calculated across all 11 dimensions, not separately within each higher-order composite.

### Audio-Visual Synesthesia.

Ratings were markedly higher in symmetric VR ( $M = 38.85$ ,  $SD = 33.23$ ) and asymmetric VR ( $M = 34.44$ ,  $SD = 30.60$ ) than in the dark-screen control ( $M = 11.09$ ,  $SD = 17.82$ ). The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is [REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]. The corresponding Bayesian evidence was  $BF_{10} = 416,663.96$ ; the data were over 400,000 times more likely under the condition model than under the order-only model. Pooled VR exceeded the control,  $t(38) = 5.15$ ,  $d_z = 0.82$ ,  $q_{FDR} < .001$ ,  $BF_{10} = 2,408.46$ , whereas symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ reliably,  $t(38) = 1.41$ ,  $d_z = 0.23$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  $BF_{01} = 2.32$ . The repeated-measures and distribution-free analyses supported the condition effect. The directional analysis strongly favored asymmetric VR over control,  $BF_{10} = 745.10$ , but did not clearly distinguish symmetric from asymmetric VR. The exploratory order effect was nominally significant before correction but not afterward ( $p = .010$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .085$ ); the condition-by-order interaction was not supported ( $q_{FDR} = .819$ ). Both VR conditions produced a large increase in Audio-Visual Synesthesia, with no reliable difference between mappings. There was no reliable evidence that the result was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

### Elementary Imagery.

Ratings were higher in symmetric VR ( $M = 26.51$ ,  $SD = 28.07$ ) and asymmetric VR ( $M = 28.78$ ,  $SD = 26.81$ ) than in the dark-screen control ( $M = 7.73$ ,  $SD = 13.43$ ). The registered order-adjusted three-condition result is [REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATISTICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK]. The corresponding Bayesian evidence was  $BF_{10} = 7,796.37$ ; the data were almost 7,800 times more likely under the condition model than under the order-only model. Pooled VR exceeded the control,  $t(38) = 4.71$ ,  $d_z = 0.75$ ,  $q_{FDR} < .001$ ,  $BF_{10} = 669.92$ , whereas symmetric and asymmetric VR did not differ,  $t(38) = -0.69$ ,  $d_z = -0.11$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  $BF_{01} = 4.65$ . The repeated-measures and distribution-free analyses supported the same conclusion. Exploratory checks found neither an order effect ( $q_{FDR} = .421$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{FDR} = .872$ ). Both VR conditions strongly increased Elementary Imagery relative to control, without evidence of a difference between the mappings. There was no reliable evidence that the result was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

### 323 **Complex Imagery.**

324 Mean ratings were 15.41 ( $SD = 17.99$ ) in the dark-screen control, 16.38 ( $SD =$   
325 17.87) in symmetric VR, and 13.55 ( $SD = 16.31$ ) in asymmetric VR. The registered  
326 order-adjusted three-condition result is [**REGISTERED OMNIBUS STATIS-**  
327 **TICS PENDING OSF SOURCE LOCK**]. The Bayesian analysis favored the  
328 order-only model,  $BF_{01} = 8.83$ ; the data were approximately nine times more likely  
329 without a condition effect. Neither pooled VR versus control,  $t(38) = -0.12$ ,  $d_z =$   
330  $-0.02$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .901$ ,  $BF_{01} = 5.75$ , nor symmetric versus asymmetric VR,  $t(38) = 1.22$ ,  
331  $d_z = 0.20$ ,  $q_{FDR} = .766$ ,  $BF_{01} = 2.91$ , provided reliable evidence of a difference.  
332 The sensitivity and distribution-free analyses agreed. Exploratory checks found nei-  
333 ther an order effect ( $q_{FDR} = .980$ ) nor a condition-by-order interaction ( $q_{FDR} = .872$ ).  
334 Complex Imagery was comparable across the three conditions. There was no reliable  
335 evidence that it was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three  
336 conditions.

337

### 338 **S3.4 Summary of fine-grained subscale contributions**

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340 The Positive Effects increase was principally associated with Experience of Unity  
341 and Changed Meaning of Percepts, followed by Disembodiment and Spiritual Expe-  
342 rience. Together, these four fine-grained subscales account arithmetically for nearly  
343 nine-tenths of the composite increase. Their items assess experiences such as reduced  
344 separation between oneself and the environment, time or apparent contradictions  
345 merging into a unified whole, ordinary objects acquiring unusual significance or emo-  
346 tional salience, diminished bodily presence or floating sensations, and feelings of awe or  
347 spiritual connection. Blissful State and Insightfulness contributed comparatively little  
348 and did not change reliably, indicating that the Positive Effects result did not pri-  
349 marily reflect greater pleasure, inner peace, love, cognitive clarity, or original thought.  
350 The resulting profile is therefore better characterized as increased unity, altered mean-  
351 ing, bodily-boundary changes, and modest transcendence than as a general increase  
352 in positive mood.

353 The smaller Distressing Effects increase was distributed across Impaired Control  
354 and Cognition and Anxiety, with Impaired Control and Cognition making the some-  
355 what larger contribution. Their items assess experiences such as diminished personal  
356 agency, difficulty making decisions or sustaining a coherent thought, feelings of paral-  
357 ysis or isolation, unexplained fear, perceived threat, strangely altered surroundings,  
358 and anticipation that something harmful might occur. Both subscales were descrip-  
359 tively higher during VR, but neither remained significant after correction across the 11  
360 dimensions, and their Bayesian results did not clearly distinguish effect from null mod-  
361 els. The significant composite result is therefore best interpreted as the accumulation  
362 of two modest and compatible distress-related tendencies rather than as a pronounced  
363 or clearly localized adverse effect.

364 The Perceptual Effects increase was almost entirely associated with Audio-Visual  
365 Synesthesia and Elementary Imagery. These subscales assess phenomena such as  
366 sounds appearing to influence perceived shapes or colors and the perception of simple  
367 patterns, colors, lights, or flashes. Complex Imagery, which instead assesses vivid inter-  
368 nally generated scenes, memories, fantasy images, and imaginative content, remained

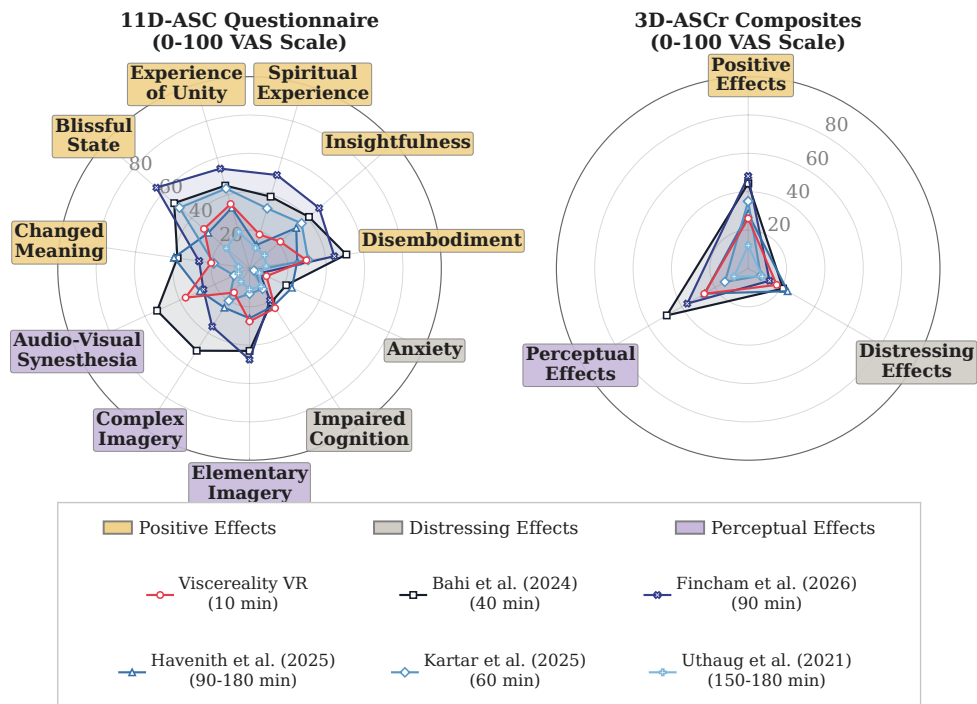


unchanged. The perceptual result therefore reflects elementary visual phenomena and perceived cross-modal influence rather than a general intensification of internally generated imagery. Because the strongest item themes closely resemble properties directly supplied by the visually rich VR environment, the magnitude of this composite also reflects overlap between the intervention content and the questionnaire’s perceptual criteria. Across all fine-grained subscales, there was no reliable symmetric-versus-asymmetric difference and no FDR-corrected evidence that the condition pattern was influenced by the order in which participants underwent the three conditions.

### S3.5 Descriptive cross-study context

The pooled Viscerality VR profile was compared descriptively with five breathwork datasets: conscious connected breathing (Bahi et al. 2024), the 90-minute breathwork arm of Airways to Alteration (Fincham et al. 2026), facilitated circular breathwork (Havenith et al. 2025), high-ventilation breathwork with music in an MRI/laboratory setting (Kartar et al. 2025), and Holotropic Breathwork (Uthaug et al. 2021). Viscerality fell within the range of several longer breathwork datasets and showed comparatively lower Distressing Effects than facilitated circular breathwork. Differences in breathing technique, duration, sample, music, facilitation, setting, and control structure preclude inferential comparison or claims of equivalence.

# Cross-Study ASC Profile Comparison



**Fig. S1** Descriptive cross-study comparison of the present dataset with five named breathwork datasets. The left panel shows 11D-ASC subscale means and the right panel shows 3D-ASC composite means. The Viscerality profile pools the symmetric and asymmetric VR conditions. Lines show raw 0–100 profile means, not standardized effect sizes; differences in technique, duration, sample, music, facilitation, and study design preclude inferential comparison. Legend order is purely graphical and does not imply a numbered study sequence.

At subscale level, the profiles differed most in Experience of Unity, Spiritual Experience, Blissful State, Disembodiment, Insightfulness, and Changed Meaning of Percepts. Changed Meaning of Percepts increased in pooled VR relative to the dark-screen control in the present study, whereas Insightfulness did not change reliably. Because the reference studies differ on multiple procedural and contextual dimensions, these profile differences do not identify the mechanism responsible for any between-study contrast.

|                                                                                          |     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| <b>S4 Pictographic self-related measures and ASC</b>                                     | 461 |
| <b>correspondence</b>                                                                    | 462 |
|                                                                                          | 463 |
| <b>S4.1 Scoring and analytic approach</b>                                                | 464 |
|                                                                                          | 465 |
| These post hoc analyses examined whether participant-level changes in the three picto-   | 466 |
| graphic self-related measures corresponded with changes in ASC outcomes. They were       | 467 |
| not specified in the preregistration and are treated as exploratory. Only SFoRC showed   | 468 |
| a reliable pooled-VR-versus-dark-screen-control condition effect; the analyses below     | 469 |
| therefore do not assume that VR changed all three pictographic outcomes. Instead,        | 470 |
| they test whether individual differences in their change scores corresponded with        | 471 |
| changes in subjective experience. For construct-oriented interpretation, we focused      | 472 |
| on ASC subscales and items concerning unity with the environment, spatial or bod-        | 473 |
| ily disembodiment, blissful experience, and spiritual experience. This thematic focus    | 474 |
| determined which findings were highlighted in the main article, but all significance     | 475 |
| decisions were based on correction across the complete composite, subscale, or item-     | 476 |
| level screen. The released Perceived Body Boundaries pictograph progresses from a        | 477 |
| diffuse silhouette at A to a sharply delineated silhouette at G. Because the stored A–G  | 478 |
| coding maps these responses to 1–7, higher stored values indicate stronger bound-        | 479 |
| ary salience. We reversed this score for the analyses in this section so that higher     | 480 |
| values indicate greater boundary dissolution. Higher SFoRC and Small Self ratings        | 481 |
| respectively indicate greater perceived extension of the self into surrounding space and | 482 |
| greater self-diminishment relative to the surroundings.                                  | 483 |
| The primary estimand was the Spearman correlation between pooled-VR-minus-               | 484 |
| dark-screen-control changes in each pictograph and the corresponding change in each      | 485 |
| ASC outcome. This tests whether participants showing larger VR-related changes in        | 486 |
| pictographic self-representation also showed larger VR-related changes in subjective     | 487 |
| effects. Two-sided permutation $p$ values used 10,000 random permutations, and per-      | 488 |
| centile confidence intervals used 2,000 participant-bootstrap resamples. To examine      | 489 |
| mapping specificity, we separately correlated symmetric-minus-asymmetric changes         | 490 |
| and tested condition-by-pictograph interactions in order-adjusted participant fixed-     | 491 |
| effects models with participant-clustered covariance. Pictograph ratings were centered   | 492 |
| within participant for the interaction models. Benjamini–Hochberg correction was         | 493 |
| applied separately across the 9 composite, 33 subscale, and 126 item-level associations  | 494 |
| and separately within each interaction family.                                           | 495 |
|                                                                                          | 496 |
| <b>S4.2 Composite-level correspondence</b>                                               | 497 |
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**Table S5** Pooled-VR-minus-dark-screen-control change correlations between pictographic measures and 3D-ASCr composites.

| Composite           | Boundary dissolution | SFoRC      | Small Self |
|---------------------|----------------------|------------|------------|
| Positive Effects    | .25 (.276)           | .70 (.001) | .46 (.015) |
| Distressing Effects | -.04 (.885)          | .07 (.842) | .02 (.885) |
| Perceptual Effects  | .20 (.334)           | .21 (.334) | .28 (.234) |

*Note.* Cells report Spearman  $\rho$  with the Benjamini–Hochberg  $q$  value in parentheses. Correction was applied across all nine pictograph–composite tests. Boundary dissolution is reverse-scored so that higher values indicate greater dissolution.

Table S5 reports the complete pictograph–3D-ASCr composite screen. Greater SFoRC extension covaried strongly with greater Positive Effects,  $\rho = .70$ ,  $q = .001$ . Greater Small Self ratings also covaried with Positive Effects,  $\rho = .46$ ,  $q = .015$ . Boundary dissolution did not show a reliable association with Positive Effects, and none of the pictographs showed a correction-robust association with Distressing or Perceptual Effects. Rank-partial follow-ups controlling the other two pictographs retained the Positive Effects associations for SFoRC, partial  $r = .64$ ,  $q < .001$ , and Small Self, partial  $r = .38$ ,  $q = .028$ , but not boundary dissolution, partial  $r = .04$ ,  $q = .802$ ; these three follow-ups were corrected together.

### S4.3 Fine-grained ASC correspondence

Table S6 reports all 33 pictograph–subscale associations. The SFoRC association with Positive Effects was distributed across Experience of Unity, Blissful State, Insightfulness, and Spiritual Experience. The association with Disembodiment was more moderate and did not survive correction across the full subscale family,  $\rho = .36$ ,  $q = .081$ . Greater Small Self ratings covaried with Blissful State, Spiritual Experience, and Audio-Visual Synesthesia. Boundary dissolution did not show a correction-robust association with any ASC subscale, including Disembodiment,  $\rho = .11$ ,  $q = .591$ .

**Table S6** Pooled-VR-minus-dark-screen-control change correlations between pictographic measures and all 11 ASC subscales.

| ASC subscale                   | Boundary dissolution | SFoRC       | Small Self  |
|--------------------------------|----------------------|-------------|-------------|
| Experience of Unity            | .14 (.492)           | .68 (.002)  | .36 (.081)  |
| Spiritual Experience           | .19 (.357)           | .41 (.049)  | .46 (.021)  |
| Blissful State                 | .24 (.277)           | .65 (.002)  | .52 (.012)  |
| Insightfulness                 | .29 (.174)           | .51 (.012)  | .36 (.081)  |
| Disembodiment                  | .11 (.591)           | .36 (.081)  | .22 (.292)  |
| Impaired Control and Cognition | .19 (.357)           | .28 (.188)  | .15 (.469)  |
| Anxiety                        | -.25 (.259)          | -.32 (.114) | -.09 (.644) |
| Complex Imagery                | .21 (.331)           | .04 (.867)  | .01 (.969)  |
| Elementary Imagery             | -.09 (.660)          | .22 (.295)  | .01 (.969)  |
| Audio-Visual Synesthesia       | .23 (.277)           | .33 (.114)  | .47 (.021)  |
| Changed Meaning of Percepts    | .13 (.538)           | .36 (.081)  | .20 (.331)  |

*Note.* Cells report Spearman  $\rho$  with the Benjamini–Hochberg  $q$  value in parentheses. Correction was applied across all 33 pictograph–subscale tests.

Item-level follow-ups clarified the content of these associations. Within Disembodiment, SFoRC change covaried with floating,  $\rho = .55$ ,  $q = .015$ , and altered self-location outside the body,  $\rho = .45$ ,  $q = .044$ , but not with bodylessness. The broader item-level SFoRC pattern also included all three Blissful State items and three Experience of Unity items. Small Self associations included items concerning inner peace, pleasure, spiritual connection, and sound-related colour changes. Table S7 reports every association surviving correction across all 126 item-level tests; no boundary-dissolution association survived this correction.

**Table S7** Item-level pictograph–ASC associations surviving correction across 126 tests.

| Pictograph | Item | Subscale                       | Brief content                  | $\rho$ ( $q$ ) |
|------------|------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------|
| SFoRC      | Q39  | Blissful State                 | Inner peace                    | .69 (.008)     |
| SFoRC      | Q15  | Experience of Unity            | Unity with environment         | .64 (.008)     |
| SFoRC      | Q18  | Experience of Unity            | Timelessness                   | .58 (.008)     |
| SFoRC      | Q19  | Experience of Unity            | Resolution of conflict         | .57 (.013)     |
| SFoRC      | Q29  | Disembodiment                  | Floating                       | .55 (.015)     |
| SFoRC      | Q03  | Blissful State                 | Boundless pleasure             | .51 (.016)     |
| Small Self | Q39  | Blissful State                 | Inner peace                    | .51 (.016)     |
| Small Self | Q34  | Audio-Visual Synesthesia       | Sound-related colour change    | .49 (.017)     |
| SFoRC      | Q12  | Changed Meaning of Percepts    | Altered meaning                | .49 (.028)     |
| SFoRC      | Q24  | Insightfulness                 | Profundity                     | .47 (.028)     |
| SFoRC      | Q36  | Impaired Control and Cognition | Reduced personal will          | .48 (.033)     |
| SFoRC      | Q16  | Impaired Control and Cognition | Difficulty judging importance  | .45 (.039)     |
| Small Self | Q02  | Spiritual Experience           | Connection to a superior power | .46 (.044)     |
| Small Self | Q03  | Blissful State                 | Boundless pleasure             | .45 (.044)     |
| SFoRC      | Q41  | Blissful State                 | All-embracing love             | .44 (.044)     |
| SFoRC      | Q28  | Disembodiment                  | Location outside the body      | .45 (.044)     |

*Note.* Item descriptions are concise content labels rather than replacements for the administered questionnaire wording.  $q$  values control the false-discovery rate across all 126 pictograph–item tests.

#### S4.4 Intervention and condition specificity

The primary change-score results explicitly concern intervention-related change: they correlate each participant’s pooled-VR-minus-control pictograph change with that participant’s pooled-VR-minus-control ASC change. To test whether correspondence instead depended on the visual mapping, we repeated the analysis using symmetric-minus-asymmetric change scores. No association survived correction among the nine 3D-ASCr composite tests (minimum  $q = .142$ ) or the 33 subscale tests (minimum  $q = .082$ ). Thus, the data did not establish that participants showing a larger pictographic response to one VR mapping also showed a larger ASC response to that mapping.

The participant fixed-effects interaction models gave the same overall conclusion about mapping specificity. No symmetric-versus-asymmetric pictograph-slope interaction survived correction for any composite (all  $q \geq .959$ ) or subscale (all  $q \geq .999$ ). The omnibus condition-by-SFoRC interaction for Positive Effects survived correction across the nine composite models,  $q = .038$ , but neither the planned pooled-VR-versus-control slope contrast,  $q = .111$ , nor the symmetric-versus-asymmetric slope contrast,  $q = .959$ , survived correction. We therefore treat that omnibus result as inconclusive

rather than as evidence that condition reliably changed the SFoRC–Positive Effects relationship.

Taken together, the exploratory analyses show that participants with larger pooled VR-related increases in spatial self-extension also tended to show larger increases in Unity and Positive Effects. SFoRC was also the only pictographic measure showing a reliable pooled-VR-versus-dark-screen-control condition effect, making these associations the clearest evidence of coordinated intervention-related variation across the two measurement domains. Small Self change covaried with blissful and spiritual experience, but no overall VR-related Small Self effect was established. Boundary dissolution showed no correction-robust association with its thematically closest ASC subscale, Disembodiment. None of these relationships was specific to the symmetric or asymmetric mapping. These exploratory associations may highlight overlap between the measurement domain of the sense of self assessed through pictographs and the subjective phenomenology captured by ASC subdomains.

## S5 Temporal experience tracer analyses

### S5.1 Task and data reduction

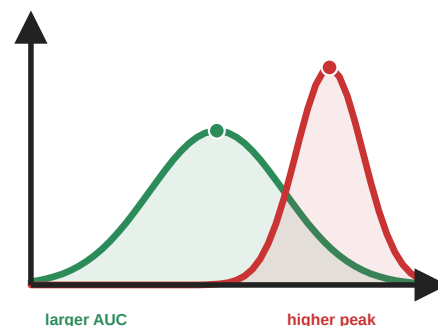
Temporal experience tracers are psychometric time-series ratings in which participants retrospectively draw intensity curves for specified experiential dimensions over a session’s time course (Jachs 2021; Damci et al. 2023; Lewis-Healey et al. 2024). Unlike global retrospective ratings, tracers preserve temporal dynamics. For each of the 11 ASC dimensions, one prompt consolidates the constituent questionnaire items into a construct-level description, yielding one tracer per dimension rather than 42 item-level ratings.

After each condition, participants draw the 11 intensity curves on a world-space time-by-intensity surface using the VR controller. We project controller position onto the drawing plane, gate input through a trigger hold, and emit points at constant spatial spacing regardless of hand speed. We map reconstructed time and intensity to normalized 0–1 coordinates. Peak is the maximum sampled intensity. AUC is the trapezoidal integral of intensity after ordering points by reconstructed time, normalized to the 0–1 plotting interval. We analyse peak and AUC as separate exploratory families.

### S5.2 Condition contrasts

Tracer peak and AUC profiles broadly follow the condition profiles observed for

**Temporal Trace Profiles:  
Peak versus Area Under the Curve**



**Fig. S2 Temporal experience tracers: peak and cumulative intensity.** These hypothetical profiles illustrate information retained by psychometric time-series intensity ratings but not by a single retrospective visual-analogue-scale response. The red profile has a higher momentary peak, whereas the broader green profile has a larger area under the curve (AUC), reflecting greater cumulative intensity. Analyses in this paper focus on these two summaries because no hypothesis required finer-grained temporal features.

the 11D-ASC questionnaire, with the strongest pooled-VR differences clustering on Experience of Unity, Elementary Imagery, and Audio-Visual Synesthesia (Figure S3). After correction across the 11 dimensions within each tracer family, pooled VR exceeded the dark-screen control for all three dimensions for both peak and AUC. The paired effects were moderate for Experience of Unity and Audio-Visual Synesthesia and large for Elementary Imagery. Several smaller nominal differences did not survive FDR correction. No symmetric-versus-asymmetric comparison survived correction.

**Table S8** Exploratory paired contrasts for tracer peak and AUC summaries ( $N = 39$ ). VR denotes the mean of the symmetric and asymmetric VR conditions. All tests have 38 degrees of freedom. Benjamini–Hochberg adjustment was performed separately across the 11 dimensions for each tracer summary and contrast.

| Summary | Dimension | Pooled VR vs control |       |        |        | Symmetric vs asymmetric |       |      |      |
|---------|-----------|----------------------|-------|--------|--------|-------------------------|-------|------|------|
|         |           | $t$                  | $d_z$ | $p$    | $q$    | $t$                     | $d_z$ | $p$  | $q$  |
| Peak    | EU        | 2.93                 | 0.47  | .006   | .021   | 0.83                    | 0.13  | .413 | .780 |
|         | SE        | 0.50                 | 0.08  | .622   | .684   | −0.94                   | −0.15 | .352 | .780 |
|         | BS        | −0.67                | −0.11 | .508   | .621   | 0.28                    | 0.04  | .784 | .784 |
|         | IS        | 2.18                 | 0.35  | .035   | .090   | 0.78                    | 0.12  | .440 | .780 |
|         | DIS       | 2.12                 | 0.34  | .041   | .090   | −1.48                   | −0.24 | .146 | .780 |
|         | ICC       | 1.80                 | 0.29  | .079   | .124   | 0.56                    | 0.09  | .579 | .780 |
|         | ANX       | 1.84                 | 0.29  | .074   | .124   | 0.78                    | 0.12  | .441 | .780 |
|         | CI        | 0.10                 | 0.02  | .920   | .920   | 0.57                    | 0.09  | .574 | .780 |
|         | EI        | 6.98                 | 1.12  | < .001 | < .001 | 0.37                    | 0.06  | .713 | .784 |
|         | AVS       | 3.34                 | 0.54  | .002   | .010   | 0.89                    | 0.14  | .377 | .780 |
|         | CMP       | 1.63                 | 0.26  | .112   | .155   | 0.47                    | 0.08  | .638 | .780 |
| AUC     | EU        | 3.26                 | 0.52  | .002   | .009   | 1.31                    | 0.21  | .199 | .850 |
|         | SE        | 0.76                 | 0.12  | .453   | .553   | −0.70                   | −0.11 | .490 | .850 |
|         | BS        | −0.38                | −0.06 | .704   | .774   | 0.39                    | 0.06  | .695 | .850 |
|         | IS        | 2.24                 | 0.36  | .031   | .057   | 0.80                    | 0.13  | .430 | .850 |
|         | DIS       | 2.37                 | 0.38  | .023   | .057   | −1.19                   | −0.19 | .240 | .850 |
|         | ICC       | 2.29                 | 0.37  | .028   | .057   | 0.26                    | 0.04  | .794 | .873 |
|         | ANX       | 1.55                 | 0.25  | .129   | .178   | 0.88                    | 0.14  | .382 | .850 |
|         | CI        | 0.14                 | 0.02  | .886   | .886   | 0.67                    | 0.11  | .507 | .850 |
|         | EI        | 7.25                 | 1.16  | < .001 | < .001 | 0.49                    | 0.08  | .627 | .850 |
|         | AVS       | 3.58                 | 0.57  | < .001 | .005   | 0.02                    | 0.00  | .985 | .985 |
|         | CMP       | 1.62                 | 0.26  | .113   | .178   | 0.42                    | 0.07  | .677 | .850 |

### S5.3 ASC–tracer correspondence

The questionnaire, tracer-peak, and tracer-AUC profiles show broadly similar relative patterns across the 11 dimensions (Figure S3). This comparison is descriptive: observations from the three conditions are nested within 39 participants, and no dependence-aware correspondence model was specified. The present results therefore

691 support profile-level convergence, rather than demonstrating that the measurement  
692 formats are interchangeable.

693 Collecting one explained tracer for each dimension could, in principle, reduce 42  
694 item-level responses to 11 construct-level ratings while retaining distinctions between  
695 momentary peaks and cumulative experience. This may make assessment faster and  
696 more engaging, but the present study did not directly compare completion time,  
697 burden, enjoyment, reliability, or validity. Whether explanatory tracer prompts can  
698 replace or complement the 11D-ASC therefore requires dedicated validation, including  
699 dependence-aware correspondence analyses and tests of whether peak, AUC, or finer  
700 temporal features explain global retrospective ratings.

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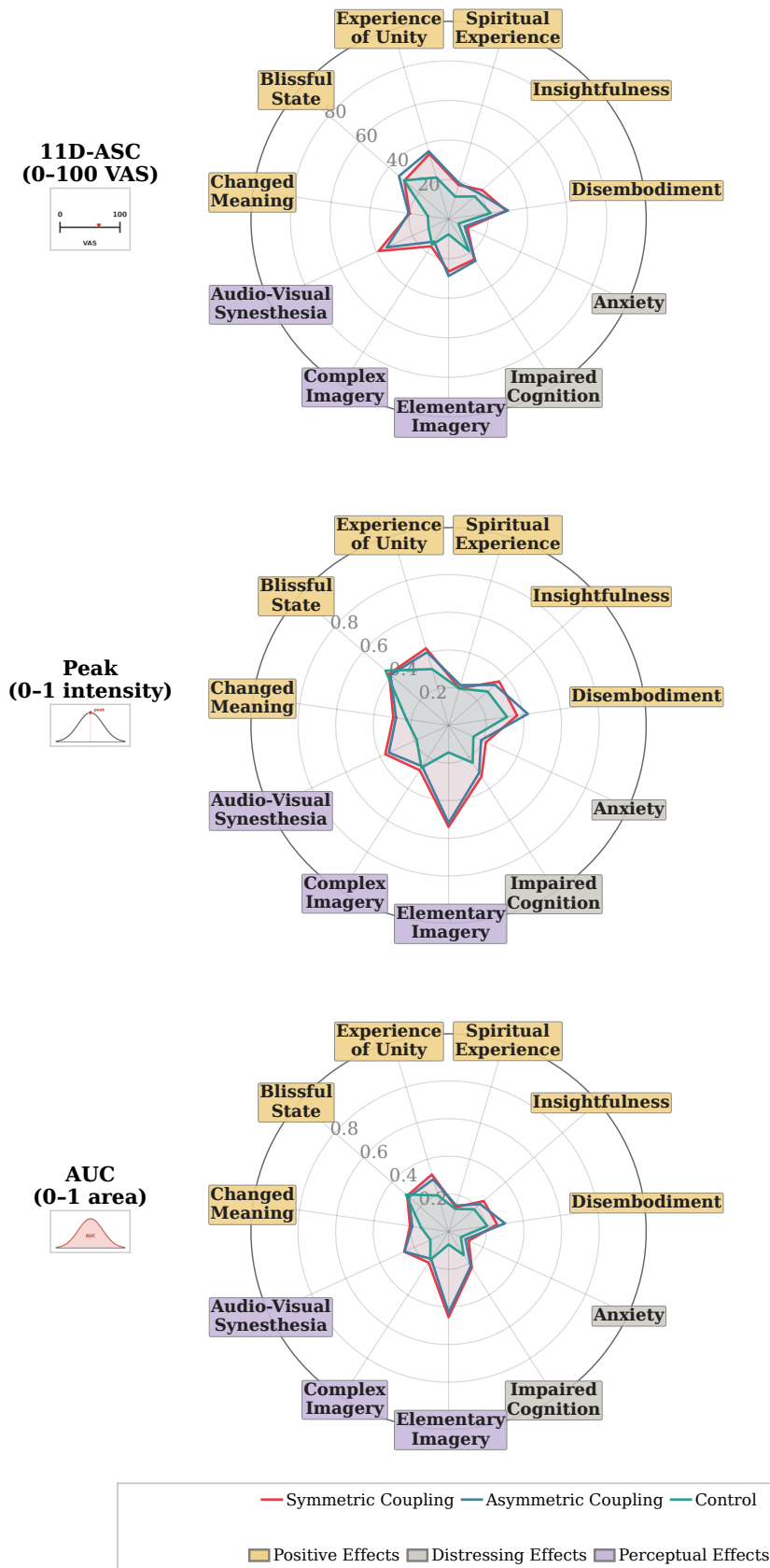
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**Fig. S3** Condition-wise altered-state profiles across all 11 dimensions for retrospective 11D-ASC questionnaire ratings (top; 0–100 visual-analogue scale), tracer peak intensity (middle; normalized 0–1 intensity), and tracer AUC (bottom; normalized 0–1 area). Lines show condition means for the included sample ( $N = 39$ ). Separate radial scales are used; comparisons should concern profile shape and condition separation rather than absolute height across measurement formats.

## 802 S6 Reproducibility and file access

803  
804 The study materials and reproducibility resources are available through three comple-  
805 mentary records:

- 806 • **OSF project.** The preregistration record, deidentified participant-level data, inclu-  
807 sion indicator, statistical outputs, analysis scripts, figure-generation scripts, study  
808 materials, environment specifications, and replay instructions are available at <https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/64MWK>.  
809
- 810 • **Zenodo archival release.** An immutable archival version of the reproducibility  
811 package corresponding to the submitted manuscript is available at [https://doi.org/](https://doi.org/ZENODO_VERSION_DOI)  
812 [ZENODO\\_VERSION\\_DOI](https://doi.org/ZENODO_VERSION_DOI).
- 813 • **GitHub repository.** The version-controlled reproducibility repository is  
814 available at [https://github.com/GeorgeFejer91/0.OSF\\_reproducibility\\_package](https://github.com/GeorgeFejer91/0.OSF_reproducibility_package).  
815 The exact commit corresponding to the submitted manuscript is avail-  
816 able at [https://github.com/GeorgeFejer91/0.OSF\\_reproducibility\\_package/tree/](https://github.com/GeorgeFejer91/0.OSF_reproducibility_package/tree/FINAL.SUBMISSION_COMMIT)  
817 [FINAL.SUBMISSION\\_COMMIT](https://github.com/GeorgeFejer91/0.OSF_reproducibility_package/tree/FINAL.SUBMISSION_COMMIT).

818  
819 The GitHub repository’s Start Here documentation identifies the analysis entry  
820 points, output directories, environment files, and replay sequence.

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